

Parks Board Meeting January 20, 2026

Meeting Metadata	Details
Video Recording	https://www.youtube.com/watch?v=I95KnylIdiU
Publication Date	2026-01-21T14:11:03Z
Target Category	muncie_city

Notice: This report is provided by the [Muncie Policy Memo](#) as a public service. This summary is generated automatically using artificial intelligence from public video transcripts, both of which are prone to error. The report is intended to provide an overview of meeting business and an aid to accessing detailed information from the video recording. When accuracy is critical, please refer to the official video recording or approved minutes.

Municipal Meeting Summary Report

Meeting: Muncie Park and Recreation Board

Date: Tuesday, January 20, 2026

2. Meeting Identification & Attendance

- **Call to Order & Spoken Details:** Presiding officer Brad Marshall called the regular meeting of the Muncie Park and Recreation Board to order on Tuesday, January 20, 2026 [00:00:34](#).
- **Attendance:**
 - **Present:** Brad Marshall (President), Shannon Powers (Vice President), Ashley Wright, Chandler, Mark.
 - **Absent:** None noted. (Nikki arrived slightly after roll call).
 - **Presiding Officer:** Brad Marshall.

3. Preliminary & Procedural Business

- **Ceremonial Openings:** The board recited the Pledge of Allegiance [00:01:03](#). The board formally welcomed new member Ashley Wright [00:01:57](#).
- **Election of Officers:**

- **President:** Brad Marshall was nominated and elected President by voice vote 00:02:22.
 - **Vice President:** Shannon Powers was nominated and elected Vice President by voice vote 00:02:53.
 - **Approval of Minutes:** The minutes from the December meeting were approved by voice vote 00:03:28.
-

4. Substantive Business & Board Action

00:03:38 Superintendent Report: First Quarter Projects & Updates

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone, Superintendent.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Superintendent Malone delivered the first quarter report, focusing on park inventories, safety hazard removal, and spring/summer season preparations. Key items discussed included:
 - **McCullum Park:** A recent weather storm damaged a small basketball court hoop and a newly installed bath house roof (up less than two weeks). CRG provided a quote for a new basketball goal and backboard set. Plumbing is slated to be routed inside the building to prevent freezing/rust issues, utilizing JBird and team. Gutters are needed on the front of the cabin to prevent foundation and entryway water pooling.
 - **Heekin Park / Hein Location:** A neighborhood meeting is scheduled regarding the tennis/pickleball courts and the bowl-shaped playground that holds water. Flatlands provided a quote suggesting the structure is solid enough to resurface. The 9th and Hackley sign needs replacement.
 - **Tuits (Tuhey) Pool & Park:** Noted gaps in the pool surface posing potential safety hazards. Discussed potential contractors (American Seal, Spears, Bud and Bond) for pool surface and splash pad repairs, as well as longer-term mechanical pit system upgrades.
 - **Other Parks:** Allar's playground mulch was removed with assistance from IU Health for painting/sprucing up; new mulch pending. Westside Park playground to be evaluated by Public Works.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal board vote taken.

00:18:22 Programming Report & 2026 Event Slate

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone and staff.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Reviewed the comprehensive 2026 program delivery schedule:
 - Summer program (6 weeks in field, 8 weeks total including pre/post planning) coordinated with YMCA, Buy Center, and White Neighborhood Association.
 - National Parks Day slated for May 16th at Westside Park.

- Flag football (May 20<U+2013>June 10 at the Ballpark) partnered with Brandon Hayes (Third and 11th). Contracts/legal language being reviewed by Aubrey Chris and John Mohan for February approval.
- Pickleball tournament tentative dates: June 13<U+2013>14 at Heekin/Haltman and Cowan Park.
- Basketball clinics/tournaments at Heekin and McCullum (June 15<U+2013>18, plus June 5<U+2013>7 and August 7<U+2013>9 tournaments) in partnership with Midwest Flex, Boys & Girls Club, and Zion Strong.
- Baseball clinics with Cowan / Barn Academy at McCullum Park.
- Track and field partnership planned with Muncie Community Schools to provide additional meets.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational report; no formal vote taken.

00:29:52 Event Approval: Black Expo Chapter Annual Community Event

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Tasha Barnes.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Presented the annual Black Expo chapter community event scheduled for July 23<U+2013>26, bringing 150<U+2013>200 people, food/retail vendors, and private security (Tasha Barnes' private company used previously). Parks provide trash totes, tents, bleachers, and porta-potties as part of a long-standing partnership.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** None.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote 00:33:53.

00:34:00 Event Approval: Forward Visions Music Festival (Bill Dunn Musical Festival)

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Billy McIntosh, President of Forward Visions.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Billy McIntosh presented the 6th-year musical festival at McCullum Park scheduled for June 27 (with setup/cleanup June 26<U+2013>28). The event promotes student arts, showcases local middle/high school student musicians, and awards \$1,000 scholarships (at least 3 awarded annually). Anticipates 250<U+2013>500 attendees, ~7 vendors, and private security (Legacy Security). Requested in-kind park support (stages, tents, cabins, porta-potties) and discussed financial sponsorship/grant opportunities.
- **Item-Specific Public Input:** Billy McIntosh testified on behalf of the nonprofit.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Approved by Voice Vote (including waiver of facility fees / in-kind amenities as a partnership) 00:45:10.

00:45:42 Event Discussion: Soul Bowl (SOBO) Basketball Tournament

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / SOBO Committee.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed the historic outdoor Soul Bowl basketball tournament at Heekin Park proposed for June 12<U+2013>14 (tentative dates). Features open

basketball, food/retail vendors, and private security. The board agreed to hold/reserve the dates provisionally while awaiting a full event application with insurance and vendor details next month.

- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Tentatively held dates; full application required next month. No final vote.

00:52:34 **Prairie Creek Reservoir Updates: Dock Lottery & Winter Storage Extension**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Board members / Carl Malone.
- **Deliberation Summary:**
 - **Dock Lottery:** Following positive discussions with the water company, the board discussed reinstating the dock lottery for 2026 to support revenue streams, accounting for normal attrition and campground closure impacts.
 - **Winter Storage Lease Extension:** The legal team recommended adjusting the previously discussed winter storage/campsite extension move-out date from May 4th to **April 30th** to align with a 30-day notice requirement. Property left after April 30th will be treated as abandoned property subject to disposal and potential cost recovery.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:**
 - Motion to reinstate the dock lottery for 2026: Approved by Voice Vote [00:58:16](#).
 - Motion to amend the winter storage move-out extension date from May 4th to April 30th: Approved by Voice Vote [10:05:06](#).

01:08:43 **Old Business: 501(c)(3) Nonprofit Status Presentation (MAPS)**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Cesar Galo / Shannon Powers.
- **Deliberation Summary:** Cesar Galo presented the newly incorporated 501(c)(3) nonprofit organization named **MAPS** (Muncie Alliance for Parks and Sustainability), formed in January to capture grant funding (such as USDA soil and water health grants) and financially support park and sustainability projects that the city cannot otherwise fund.
- **Action & Vote Disposition:** Informational presentation; certificate of incorporation entered on file.

01:15:46 **Old Business: Five-Year Master Plan**

- **Sponsor / Presenter:** Carl Malone / Board.
 - **Deliberation Summary:** Discussed moving forward with a Request for Quote (RFQ) / Request for Bid (RFB) to develop the upcoming 5-year master plan, incorporating data from prior surveys and upcoming public engagement sessions.
-

5. Open Public Comment / Citizen Forum

- **01:19:10 Rick Henser:** Addressed the board regarding the return of historic tournaments like Gus Macker and Soul Bowl, requested clarification on the exact number of docks to be leased following the lottery reopening, and emphasized the critical importance of protecting and cleaning Muncie's water supply.
 - **01:22:52 Aaron (Vice President, South Neighborhood Association):** Clarified that the South Neighborhood Association is bringing back the **Gus Macker** tournament at Southside Middle School parking lot on **July 17<U+2013>19** (Registration July 17, tournament July 18<U+2013>19). Noted communications with sanitation and requested potential in-kind support (bleachers, tents) from the parks department.
 - **01:25:49 Commodore (Muncie Sailing Club):** Reaffirmed the Muncie Sailing Club's ongoing commitment to supporting Prairie Creek staff, offering 12 years of technical experience, training, and assistance with dock management.
-

6. Administrative Updates & Adjournment

- **Staff / Board Announcements:** Next regular meeting scheduled for February. Staff directed to secure full event applications from event organizers.
 - **Adjournment:** Motion to adjourn moved and seconded **01:27:40**. Approved by Voice Vote and meeting adjourned **01:27:42**.
-

Muncie Policy Memo Civic Monitoring Automated Pipeline. Report generated on 2026-09-19 02:00:58 using model gemini-3.5-flash-lite.